



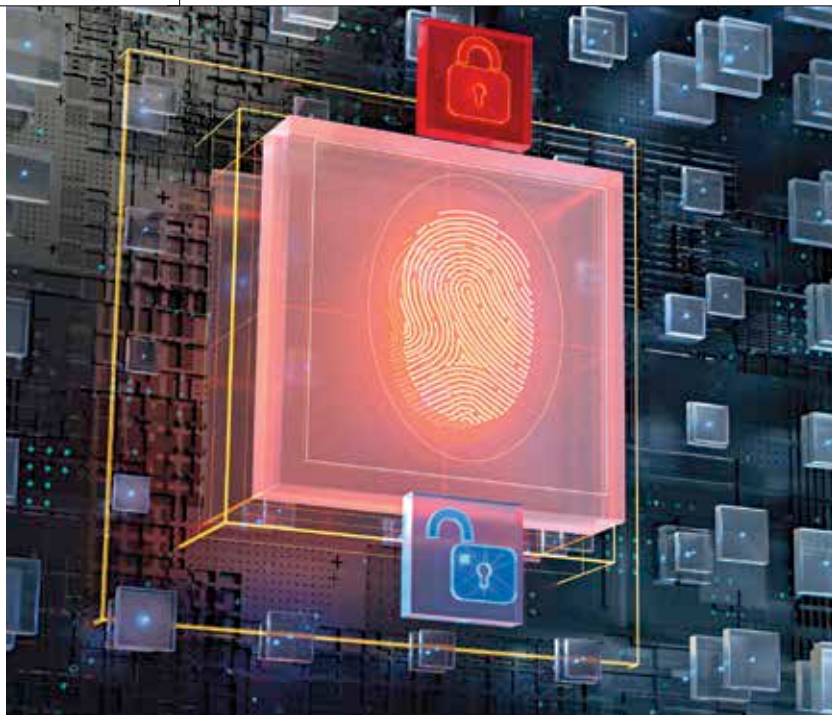
Securing biometrics

How blockchain and biometrics can feed off each other, and securing the systems that use both. <https://digit.in/jan20-83>



PatientID of the future

The benefits that a combination of blockchain and biometrics can offer to the healthcare industry. <https://digit.in/jan20-84>



BLOCKCHAIN-INFUSED BIOMETRICS

The two starkly different technologies could form an ideal couple for identity management

Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in

Blockchain is a disruptive technological advancement designed specifically to ensure data of individuals or corporations remains secure. It is a decentralised database that is secured using cryptography. This means sensitive data doesn't need to pass through centralised data aggregators, be it private organisations or the government. Access to the

data within the decentralised system is controlled by the individual who owns the data and they can choose to share it as they see fit. Integrating this revolutionary technology with biometrics can open up novel, more secure avenues for identity management and security. It can prove to be an effective way to avoid falling prey to cyber frauds, eavesdropping and hacking, which are becoming increasingly prevalent in today's connected world. The power that blockchain endows on people is that it can give them back ownership of their sensitive data to quite a large extent. With privacy concerns galore, blockchain-based biometrics can instil a renewed sense of security amongst consumers and corporations. Additionally, biometrics identity systems can also make lengthy, arduous processes revolving around identity verification much

simpler, which gives users ownership of yet another asset they lose out on regularly – time.

THE NEED FOR BLOCKCHAIN-BASED BIOMETRICS

Physical identity proof documents such as driving license, passport, and aadhar card are essential to carry out some of the most basic tasks. However, in a technologically-advanced world where AI is capable of making restaurant reservations for us, carrying around physical copies of our IDs seems like a dated practice. Additionally, ID verification processes at places such as the airport, hotels, banks and more are always laboriously long. Arriving at an airport an hour before domestic flights and 2-3 hours before international ones seem like a colossal waste of time. In order to provide a more seamless experience, multiple airports and banks are beginning to incorporate or completely rehaul identification processes with biometrics technology. In the SITA 2018 Air Transport IT Insights report, it was documented that 77 per cent of the world's airports and 71 per cent global airlines are planning major R&D in biometric ID management.

Additionally, we are already seeing major integration of biometrics in Wallet services such as Google Pay, banking apps, and even our offices! This ensures that you do not have to keep entering card or account information repeatedly to make transactions. In offices, there's no longer a need to keep physical directories of check-in and check out. Biometrics takes care of that and also ensures that dishonest practices such as a friend using your company card to swipe in your attendance in the office doesn't happen.

However, the question that often arises with biometric solutions are – Where is my data stored? Is it secure? Can it be hacked? Can someone utilise my biometrics data to authorise fund or asset transfers? The answer is yes, yes, yes, oh and, yes. Terrifying? Even for people that aren't the most paranoid about their data being stored in